

An Empty Cockpit

Air India, now owned by the Tata group, has hit an air pocket. **Ilker Ayci**, who was named as MD & CEO of Air India, has declined to take charge of the airline, citing attempts by sections of the Indian media to give a negative colour to his appointment. The top priority for the Tata group now is to get the ailing airline out of the red and a lot depends on finding a person quickly to run it. Will Air India's quest for a captain end anytime soon?

—KRISHNA GOPALAN



QUO VADIS?



THE ANNOUNCEMENT left most within aviation circles in a tizzy. Within days of his business partner Rahul Bhatia's elevation to Managing Director of IndiGo, **Rakesh Gangwal** sent in a tersely worded resignation, saying he wanted to avoid access to any unpublished price-sensitive information as he reduces his stake in the company over five years. Industry insiders say that while Bhatia has effectively managed the policy environment, it was Gangwal who laid the foundation for the market-leading airline. Having earned his stripes in the cutthroat US aviation industry, Gangwal commands tremendous goodwill. The price negotiated by him with Airbus for IndiGo's fleet is reportedly among the lowest globally. Many would now wish that he invests to build another champion airline in India.

—MANISH PANT

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Friendly Crypto-Man

Warren Buffett's Berkshire Hathaway has invested \$1 billion in Nubank, one of Brazil's largest fintech banks. Yawn, right? Well, Nubank's investment unit NuInvest facilitates investments in cryptocurrencies and Bitcoin ETFs, a category of investments derided by both Buffett and his partner Charlie Munger—Buffett once called Bitcoin “rat poison squared”, and Munger likened cryptos to venereal disease. Did something just change?

—TEENA JAIN KAUSHAL



FOOD FOR THOUGHT



Founders of listed start-ups are starting to realise that the public market is a tough nut to crack. On November 16, 2021, Zomato founder **DEEPIK GOYAL** (in picture above) held shares in his company worth ₹6,248 crore. Three months later, the recent stock market weakness has sent that value plunging by ₹3,440 crore to ₹2,808 crore (as on February 15). Private valuations probably seem like a happy dream now.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

NEXT STOP, OLYMPICS!

IT WAS IN 1983 that the **International Olympic Committee (IOC)** last held its high-powered meeting in India. So, the decision to award it to **Mumbai** for next year's session is a significant breakthrough, thanks to India's IOC member **Nita Ambani's** efforts. **Jio World convention centre** will play host to 101 voting members and 45 honor-ary members.

—KRISHNA GOPALAN



The 'First' Lady

Madhabi Puri Buch, the new Chairman of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (Sebi), has racked up quite a few firsts to her name. She is, of course, Sebi's first female chief; she was the markets regulator's first woman Whole-time Member, between April 2017 and October 2021; and the St. Stephen's College and IIM Ahmedabad alumna is the first non-bureaucrat Sebi chief since G.N. Bajpai was appointed in 2002. Will her three-year stint see more firsts at Sebi?

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR

